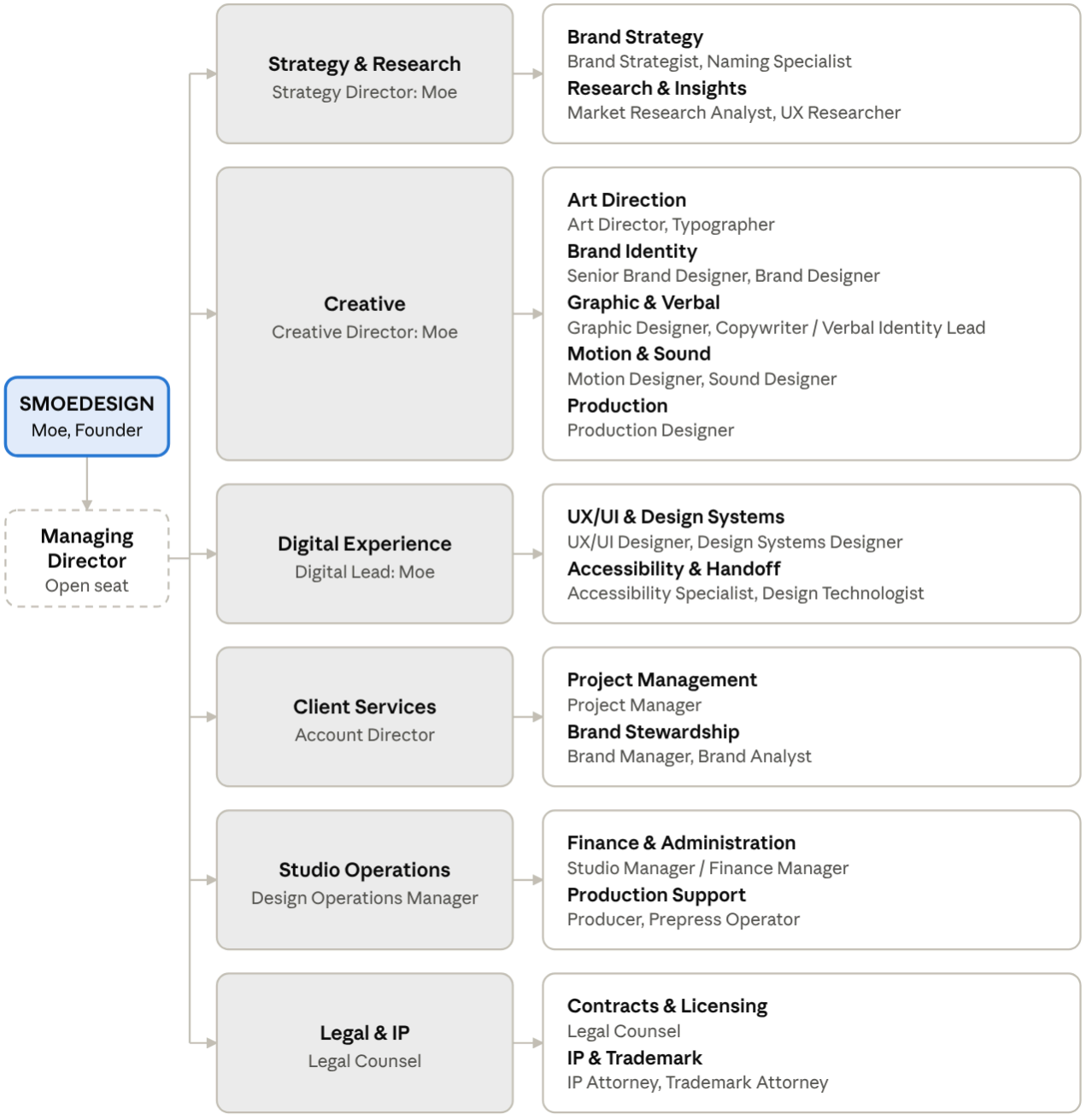
SMOEDESIGN Organization Architecture

Nov 8, 2026 · @Mohamed Salah

Organization hierarchy

Moe leads the design work; a Managing Director oversees every department



organization hierarchy · founder, 6 departments, 15 teams

Each department box shows its head's title; teams and roles sit to its right. Moe runs Strategy & Research, Creative and Digital Experience hands-on, reviewing and approving his teams' work or modifying it directly. A Managing Director, currently an open seat, oversees all six departments and reports to Moe.

Managing Director

The Managing Director reports to Moe and oversees all six departments, including the three Moe runs hands-on. Budgets, contracts and hiring were not delegated, so they stay with Moe.

Responsibility	What the Managing Director does
Client escalations	Decides client escalations without waiting for Moe
Work review	Reviews the team's work
Team follow-up	Follows the team and keeps work moving
Communication	Communicates with the team
Delegation	Delegates tasks to the right department
Reporting	Escalates to Moe and reports to him
Moe's needs	Sees Moe's needs through to delivery

Departments, teams and responsibilities

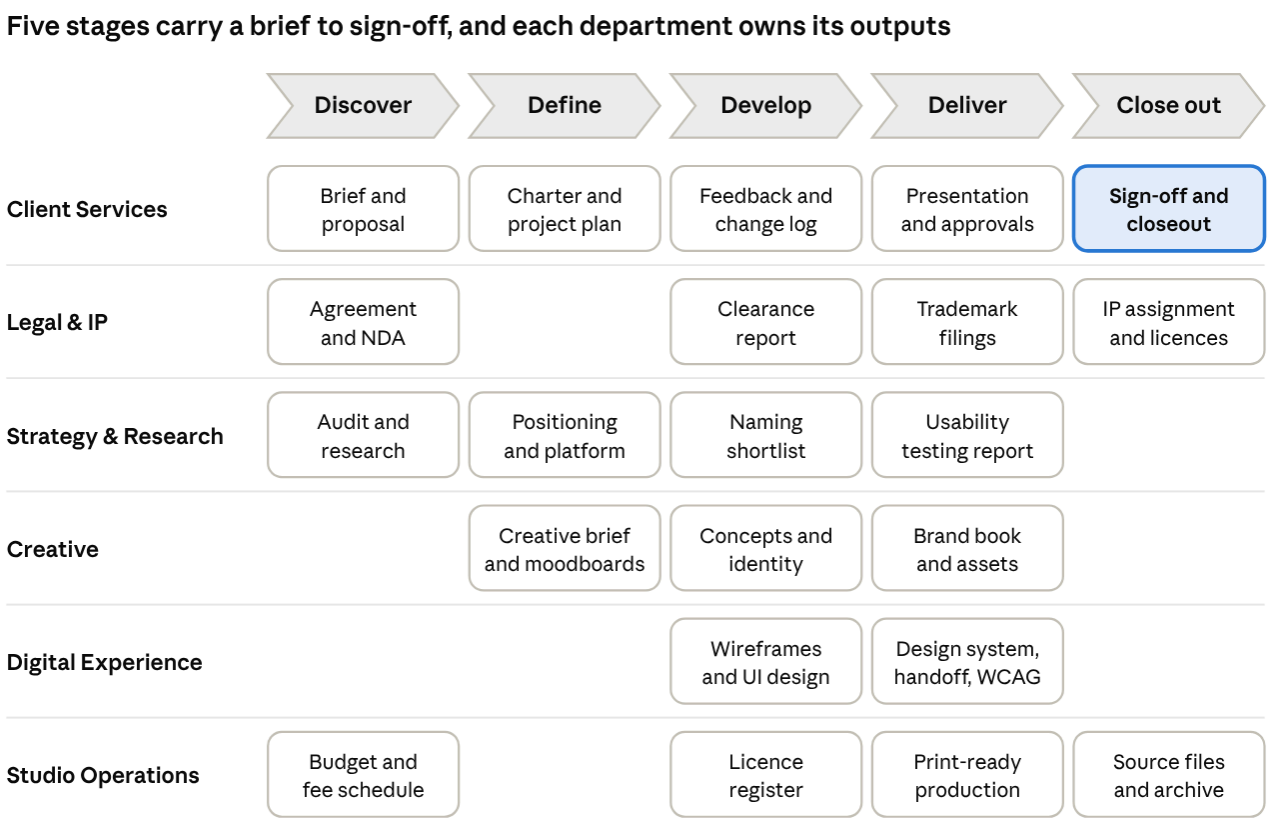
Department	Team	Roles	Core responsibilities
SMOEDESIGN	Founder	Moe, Founder	Overall direction, hands-on lead of the design work, final approval
Strategy & Research	Leadership	Strategy Director (Moe, hands-on)	Business case and design-value statement; problem statement and "How Might We" framing

Department	Team	Roles	Core responsibilities
Strategy & Research	Brand Strategy	Brand Strategist, Naming Specialist	Brand strategy on a page, stakeholder interviews, brand audit, positioning and architecture, brand platform, naming strategy
Strategy & Research	Research & Insights	Market Research Analyst, UX Researcher	Competitor and market analysis, audience research, personas, journey maps
Creative	Leadership	Creative Director (Moe, hands-on)	Creative brief, executive summary, final presentation deck
Creative	Art Direction	Art Director, Typographer	Moodboards, visual territories, imagery and illustration direction, typography system
Creative	Brand Identity	Senior Brand Designer, Brand Designer	Concept routes, logo suite, colour system, brand book
Creative	Graphic & Verbal	Graphic Designer, Copywriter / Verbal Identity Lead	Graphic elements and layout system, collateral mockups, tagline, messaging, tone of voice
Creative	Motion & Sound	Motion Designer, Sound Designer	Motion and sonic identity guidelines
Creative	Production	Production Designer	Final asset library in all formats, colour modes and sizes
Digital Experience	Leadership	Digital Lead (Moe, hands-on)	Owns the digital deliverables and their quality
Digital Experience	UX/UI & Design Systems	UX/UI Designer, Design Systems Designer	UI/UX files, wireframes, prototypes, design system and tokens, contrast and responsive specifications

Department	Team	Roles	Core responsibilities
Digital Experience	Accessibility & Handoff	Accessibility Specialist, Design Technologist	WCAG 2.2 conformance review, developer handoff specifications
Client Services	Leadership	Account Director	Proposal / statement of work, decision log and stakeholder alignment
Client Services	Project Management	Project Manager	Project charter, plan and work breakdown, RACI, communication plan, revision and change logs, risk brief, sign-off, closeout and lessons learned
Client Services	Brand Stewardship	Brand Manager, Brand Analyst	Implementation toolkit and onboarding, brand governance and maintenance, brand-usage rules, brand evaluation and KPI plan
Studio Operations	Leadership	Design Operations Manager	Source-file handover and asset structure, font and stock licence register, design maturity assessment
Studio Operations	Finance & Administration	Studio Manager / Finance Manager	Budget, fee schedule, invoicing and payment milestones
Studio Operations	Production Support	Producer, Prepress Operator	Production specifications and print-ready files, third-party licences and releases
Legal & IP	Leadership	Legal Counsel	Design services agreement, confidentiality / NDA
Legal & IP	Contracts & Licensing	Legal Counsel	Usage-rights licences, brand licensing rules with Brand Stewardship

Department	Team	Roles	Core responsibilities
Legal & IP	IP & Trademark	IP Attorney, Trademark Attorney	IP ownership clause, trademark clearance and filings, industrial design registration

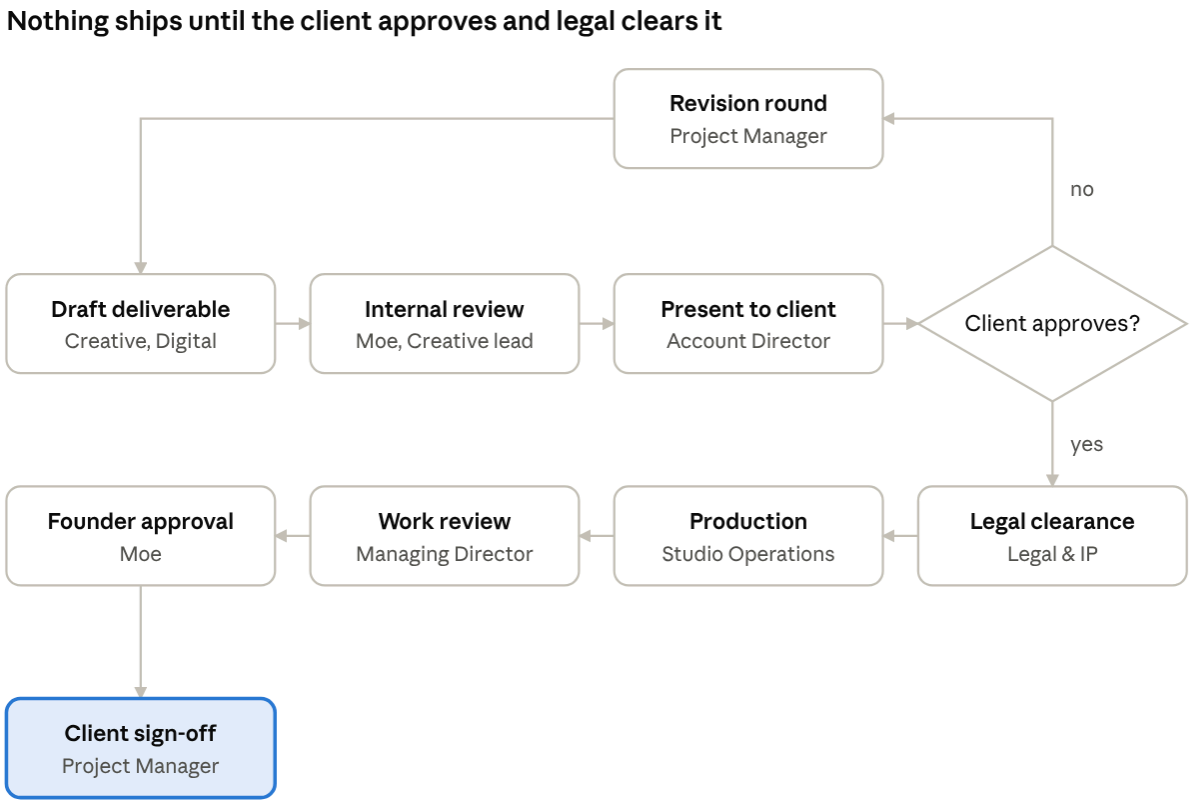
Project delivery flow



project delivery flow · 5 stages, 6 departments

Stages read left to right; client sign-off (highlighted) closes the project.

Approval and change-control flow



approval and change-control flow · 1 decision, 1 loop

A rejected review loops back to the draft through a logged revision round; an approved one passes legal clearance, production, the Managing Director's work review and founder approval before client sign-off.